CHART OF THE WEEK

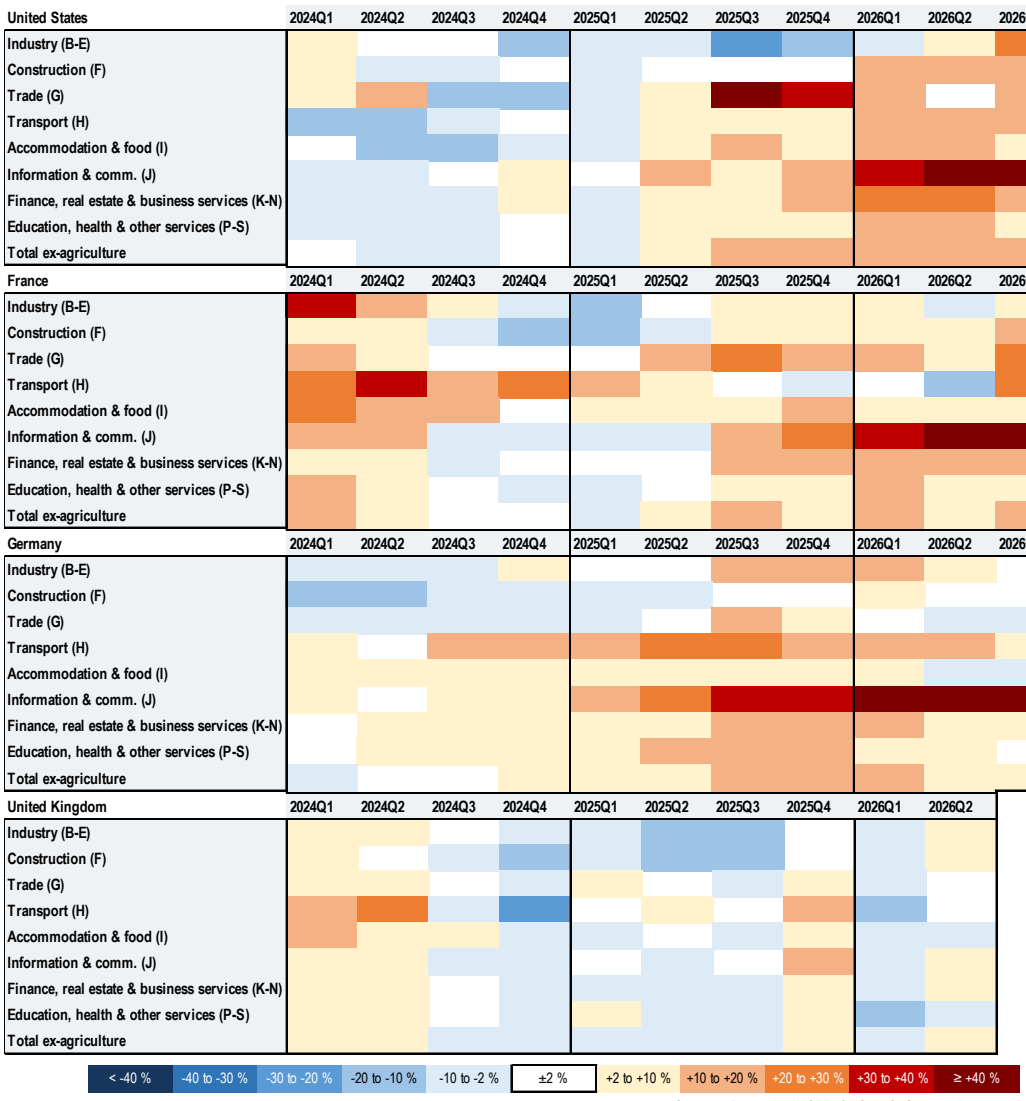
4 November 2026

AI IS BOOSTING BUSINESS CREATIONS BOTH IN THE US AND EUROPE

Stéphane Colliac

The significant increase in business creations since mid-2025 in the United States, France and Germany – and, to a lesser extent, in the United Kingdom – is continuing. Across the board, this trend is being driven by the information and communication sector and mostly by AI. It is spreading to other business services, while developments in consumer services, industry and construction are more mixed. However, in both the United States and France, the trend is broadening, suggesting that AI is facilitating business creation across all sectors.

Business creations by sector: a boom that is building momentum and spreading



Source: Destatis, INSEE, ONS, U.S. Census Bureau, BNP Paribas

We have calculated the year-on-year change in the number of new business start-ups. The table categorises these results as positive (red), neutral (white) or negative (blue). The darker the colour, the larger the change. The data series are defined as follows: Germany = new entries in the companies register (start-ups) since 2008; France = business start-ups, including micro-entrepreneurs, since 2000; United Kingdom = businesses registered for VAT/PAYE since 2017; United States = business applications (tax identification number) since 2004. Sectors have been grouped together to ensure that the classification is standardised across all countries. For the third quarter, the German data only include the months of July and August.

A noticeable boom in the United States, France, and Germany, but not quite as pronounced in the United Kingdom

The four economies for which we have comparable data (the United States, France, Germany and the United Kingdom) have all seen, to varying degrees, an increase in the number of new business creations. While the timing varies across these countries, most of them are enjoying strong momentum. In the United States, there has been a noticeable acceleration since the second quarter of 2025, which has continued to strengthen. Germany has followed a similar trajectory, moving from slight declines at the start of 2024 to sharp increases. France is experiencing the same trend but with some specific features, as momentum has picked up significantly after months of slowdown (due to the uncertainty following the dissolution of the National Assembly) and is accelerating across most sectors in 2026. In the United Kingdom, the trend is less pronounced and the increase may not last.

Business services, and AI in particular, are driving this momentum

In most of these four countries, business creations are rising significantly in the information and communication sector, which is directly linked to AI. In the United States, Germany and France, there has been a pronounced trend which is gaining momentum. In the United Kingdom, the AI sector is also seeing an increase, but it is significantly less pronounced. However, this momentum is not limited to this sector. It is spreading to many services sectors, including finance, real estate and business services. Growth has been sustained since mid-2025 in the United States and Germany, and since the third quarter of 2025 in France.

The picture for consumer services is more mixed. In the United States, trade, accommodation and catering have experienced major increases in creations since mid-2025. In France, these sectors are in positive territory, particularly trade, where the increase in business creations has recently accelerated. In Germany, these same sectors fell into negative territory in 2026 following a rather mixed year in 2025.

The situation is even more mixed for manufacturing and construction. In the United States, these sectors are also part of the overall positive momentum in the third quarter of 2026. This shows that AI does not only benefit sectors closely linked to it (notably the digital technology sector) but that it makes it easier to start a business across the entire economy (by simplifying administrative procedures in particular). In France, the upturn in business creations in the construction sector suggests that this same trend is at play, even as activity in the sector continues to contract.

Therefore, the trend is more widespread in the United States and is becoming increasingly prevalent in France. It is driven by specific sectors of the services industry in Germany, while it is significantly more subdued in the United Kingdom.

stephane.colliac@bnpparibas.com

Article written with the help of Ece Usta (intern).

GROUP ECONOMIC RESEARCH

ECOINSIGHT
Structural or thematic topics

ECOPERSPECTIVES
Analyses and forecasts with a focus on developed and emerging economies.

ECOFLASH
Data releases, major economic events

ECOWEEK
Recent economic and policy developments, data comments, economic calendar, forecasts

ECOCHARTS
Easy-to-read monthly overview of inflation dynamics

ECOATLAS
The key economic figures for France and major European economies

CHART OF THE WEEK
A weekly chart highlighting points of interest in the world economy

ECOTV
What is the key event of the month?
You will find the answer in our economy broadcast.

MACROWAVES
Our economic podcast



Published by BNP PARIBAS Economic Research
Head office: 16 boulevard des Italiens – 75009 Paris France
www.group.bnpparibas – www.economic-research.bnpparibas.com
Head of publication: Jean Lemierre / Chief editor: Isabelle Mateos y Lago
Copyright image: StreetOnCamara

The information and opinions contained in this document have been obtained from, or are based on, public sources believed to be reliable, but there is no guarantee of the accuracy, completeness or fitness for any particular purpose of such information and such information may not have been independently verified by BNPP or by any person. None of BNPP, any of its subsidiary undertakings or affiliates or its members, directors, officers, agents or employees accepts any responsibility or liability whatsoever or makes any representation or warranty, express or implied, as to the accuracy and completeness of the information or any opinions based thereon and contained in this document and it should not be relied upon as such. This document does not constitute research, as defined under MIFID II, or form any part of any offer to sell or issue and is not a solicitation of any offer to purchase any financial instrument, nor shall it or any part of it nor the fact of its distribution form the basis of, or be relied on, in connection with any contract or investment decision. Information and opinions contained in this document are published for the information of recipients, but are not to be relied upon as authoritative or taken in substitution for the exercise of judgment by any recipient, are subject to change without notice. In providing this document, BNPP does not offer investment, financial, legal, tax or any other type of advice to, nor has any fiduciary duties towards, recipients. Any reference to past performance is not indicative of future performance, which may be better or worse than prior results. Any hypothetical, past performance simulations are the result of estimates made by BNPP, as of a given moment, on the basis of parameters, market conditions, and historical data selected by BNPP, and should not be used as guidance, in any way, of future performance. To the fullest extent permitted by law, no BNPP group company accepts any liability whatsoever (including in negligence) for any direct or consequential loss arising from any use of or reliance on material contained in this document even when advised of the possibility of such losses. All estimates and opinions included in this document are made as of the date of this document. Unless otherwise indicated in this document there is no intention to update this document. BNPP may make a market in, or may, as principal or agent, buy or sell securities of any issuer or person mentioned in this document or derivatives thereon. Prices, yields and other similar information included in this document are included for information purposes however numerous factors will affect market pricing at any particular time, such information may be subject to rapid change and there is no certainty that transactions could be executed at any specified price. BNPP may have a financial interest in any issuer or person mentioned in this document, including a long or short position in their securities and/or options, futures or other derivative instruments based thereon, or vice versa. BNPP, including its officers and employees may serve or have served as an officer, director or in an advisory capacity for any person mentioned in this document. BNPP may, from time to time, solicit, perform or have performed investment banking, underwriting or other services (including acting as adviser, manager, underwriter or lender) within the last 12 months for any person referred to in this document. BNPP may be a party to an agreement with any person relating to the production of this document. BNPP may to the extent permitted by law, have acted upon or used the information contained herein or in the document, or the analysis on which it was based, before the document was published. BNPP may receive or intend to seek compensation for investment banking services in the next three months from or in relation to any person mentioned in this document. Any person mentioned in this document may have been provided with relevant sections of this document prior to its publication in order to verify its factual accuracy.

This document was produced by a BNPP group company. This document is for the use of intended recipients and may not be reproduced (in whole or in part) or delivered or transmitted to any other person without the prior written consent of BNPP. By accepting or accessing this document you agree to this.

BNP Paribas is a société anonyme incorporated in France, licensed and supervised as a credit institution by the European Central Bank (ECB) and as an investment services provider by the Autorité de contrôle prudentiel et de résolution (ACPR) and Autorité des marches financiers (AMF), and having its registered office at 16, boulevard des Italiens, 75009 Paris, France.
Some or all of the information contained in this document may already have been published on https://globalmarkets.bnpparibas.com.

For country-specific disclaimers (United States, Canada, United Kingdom, Germany, Belgium, Ireland, Italy, Netherlands, Portugal, Spain, Switzerland, Brazil, Turkey, Israel, Bahrain, South Africa, Australia, China, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, Thailand, Vietnam) please type the following URL to access the applicable legal notices: https://globalmarkets.bnpparibas.com/gm/home/Markets_360_Country_Specific_Notices.pdf

© BNP Paribas (2026). All rights reserved.

Subscribe to our publications:
ECONOMIC RESEARCH

BNP PARIBAS

The bank for a changing world